

Hackathon Challenge: Hill's Data Collaboration & Strategic Growth 2026

Welcome to the **Audencia Data Challenge 2026**. Your objective is to act as a strategic data consultancy for **Hill's Pet Nutrition**. You must leverage data collaboration to solve business challenges in an evolving digital landscape where privacy and 1st-party data are paramount.

Below are your instructions, divided into two mandatory steps.

Step 1: Building a Strategic Data Collaboration Ecosystem

To convince Hill's upper management to invest in this project, you must map a vision of a high-potential **Data Collaboration** ecosystem. Based on the case information and your research, draft a proposal that includes:

- **High-Value Partners:** Identify specific partners (e.g., retailers like **Petco** or **Petsmart**, publishers like **YouTube** or **Meta**, or specialized data providers) to join the ecosystem.
- **The Value Exchange:** Explain the added value for these partners to share their data within a **Data Clean Room** (e.g., Snowflake, Habu, or LiveRamp) and why working with them is relevant for Hill's.
- **Data Requirements:** List the specific types of data needed from Hill's (1st party CRM), the partners (2nd party transactional/loyalty), and other providers (3rd party panels) to ensure success.
- **Problem Solving:** Describe the business value this ecosystem creates and which specific problems it solves for Hill's (e.g., cookieless targeting, closed-loop measurement).

Step 2: Data-Driven Business Case & Recommendations

Now that the technical infrastructure is approved, you must use the provided datasets to build a high-value use case. You are assigned **one** of the following four Business Questions. Your goal is to analyze the data, build a storytelling narrative, and propose actionable recommendations.

Group 1: Customer Value & Demographic Profiling

- **Business Question:** How can Hill's identify "Heavy Buyers" and convert "Light Buyers" into loyal customers through demographic insights?

Group 2: Media Mix Efficiency & Attribution

- **Business Question:** What is the actual business impact of TV versus Programmatic advertising on sales, and how should the budget be reallocated?

Group 3: Budget Optimization & Frequency Capping

- **Business Question:** At what point does advertising repetition become wasteful? Determine the optimal saturation point to maximize conversions.

Group 4: Programmatic Growth & Market Opportunities

- **Business Question:** Are current web-based campaigns reaching the most profitable segments? Identify growth opportunities in under-represented high-value audiences.

Deliverables: A client deck (slides) featuring your strategic ecosystem (Step 1) and your data analysis with actionable recommendations (Step 2).

10 minutes of presentation - 5 min of questions/answers